

Illustrative render of the finished design - not a photograph of a sample

Hamish the Highland Cow

One spiral head, one spiral body · wide cream muzzle · weather-beaten fringe · seated 15 cm

CROCHET PATTERN · US TERMS · INTERMEDIATE · 6 - 8 HOURS · INK-FRIENDLY PRINT LAYOUT

✓ 5-AXIOM MATH VERIFIED ON PAPER	16 ROUNDS	9 PIECES	12 MM EYES	WORSTED #4

GINGER - MAIN OAT CREAM - MUZZLE named original colourway

WHAT YOU GET	VERIFICATION	PRINT NOTES
One-piece spiral head and body Muzzle, belly patch, legs, ears, horns Fringe, tail and optional tartan scarf	✓ 5-axiom mathematical audit All round counts re-derived exactly Paper-verified: no sample crocheted	US Letter, no full-bleed colour Tables sized for home printers Checklist and record pages included

Worked in pieces so every proportion can be pinned and checked

head, body, muzzle, belly patch, four legs, four ear layers and two horns are made separately, then sewn in the numbered assembly order; the fringe and tail are knotted yarn secured twice.

Paper-verified edition: every stitch count, repeat multiplier, chain length and decrease schedule in this document was re-derived from its own instruction text. No sample was crocheted, blocked, weighed or measured, so all sizes, yarn quantities and times are targets for you to confirm on your first make.

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Cover artwork is an illustrative render of the written design - not a photograph of a sample.

A shaggy, sturdy Highland cow with a flattened brow, a wide cream muzzle and a weather-beaten fringe. Worked in pieces so every proportion can be pinned and checked before sewing.

FINISHED SIZE About 15 cm (6 in) sitting in worsted weight. A 70 mm wide body and a 70 x 67 mm head. A low, sprawling Highland sit.

Safety — read this first

Hamish uses two 12 mm plastic safety eyes. If an eye, washer or surrounding stitch fails, it can release a small part: reach through the open head and lock each washer firmly from the inside BEFORE stuffing and closing the head (Rnd 16), then check the eye and fabric by hand. The horns, ears, muzzle, legs and tail are sewn on, and the fringe and tail are knotted yarn: sew every seam twice, weave ends in at least 5 cm, and secure every knot.

No finished Hamish has been shown by Novality Store to comply with ASTM F963, EN 71 or another toy-safety regime; do not describe one as “baby-safe” or compliant. Embroidered eyes remove the plastic-eye detachment hazard but do not by themselves establish suitability for any age. Before supplying a finished item, its maker or seller must determine all classification, assessment, testing, documentation, labelling and traceability duties for the intended and reasonably foreseeable use in every destination market.

Materials

- Yarn A - Ginger: worsted / aran (#4), about 25 g used. Caramel, toffee or ginger gold. One 80 g / 150 m ball covers about three cows at the stated gauge, including normal seaming tails.
- Yarn B - Oat cream: worsted / aran (#4), about 12 g. Muzzle, horns, inner ears, optional belly patch.
- Yarn C - Dark chocolate: worsted / aran (#4), about 5 g. Hooves and nostrils.
- Yarn D - Rust (optional): about 6 g for the scarf, or 28 cm of 12 mm tartan ribbon.
- Hook: 3.5 mm (US E-4) - smaller than the ball band so stuffing cannot show.
- Eyes: 2 x 12 mm black safety eyes, or black floss for an embroidered-eye version.
- Stuffing & notions: polyester fibre fill about 30 g (buy 50 g to over-stuff the base); stitch marker, tapestry needle, pins, scissors.

Gauge & size

Gauge in Yarn A: 11 sc x 12 rounds = 5 cm / 2 in. Not critical, but loose tension lets stuffing show - drop half a millimetre if your fabric is gappy.

Finished size: about 15 cm / 6 in sitting.

Abbreviations (US terms)

MR - magic ring · ch - chain

sl st - slip stitch · sc - single crochet

hdc - half double crochet · inc - increase (2 sc in one st)

dec - invisible decrease · BLO - back loop only

FO - fasten off · st(s) - stitch(es) · Rnd(s) - round(s)

(n) - stitch count at round end

Work in a continuous spiral unless a round says join. Mark the first stitch of every round. Leave 30-40 cm tails on every piece you will sew.

Techniques used, in the order you will meet them

The magic ring - Wrap yarn around two fingers, insert the hook, pull up a loop and work the first round into the ring; pull the tail tight once the round is complete.

Working in a spiral - Do not join and do not chain 1 between rounds. Move the marker up each time - there is no join to count from.

The invisible decrease - Insert the hook through the FRONT loops only of the next two stitches, yarn over and pull through both, then yarn over and pull through the remaining two. Every dec is worked this way - no ridge on visible rounds.

Back loop only (BLO) - Work into the far loop only, leaving the near loop unused; the unused loops form a raised ridge. Hamish's hoof line is one BLO round.

Working around a chain - For the belly patch, crochet into both sides of a starting chain: across the front, corner increases into the last chain, then back along the opposite side - turning a chain into a flat oval.

The lark's head knot - Fold a strand in half, push the folded loop under a stitch with the hook, pull the two loose ends through the loop and cinch. Used for every fringe strand and the tail.

Ladder stitch - The invisible seam: out on one side, pick up one bar on the opposite side, then one bar back, alternating, pulling snug every few stitches. The head-to-body join needs two full passes.

Instructions

1. Head - Yarn A

Worked from the crown down toward the neck. One straight round only - that is what keeps the brow flat and wide instead of egg-shaped. Close to 6 stitches at the end.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	-
R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	fringe row 3
R7	[5 sc, inc] x 6	(42)	fringe row 2 / horns
R8	[6 sc, inc] x 6	(48)	fringe row 1 / ears
R9	sc in each st around	(48)	eyes at R9 - R10
R10	[6 sc, dec] x 6	(42)	-
R11	[5 sc, dec] x 6	(36)	decreases 42 to 36
R12	[4 sc, dec] x 6	(30)	lock eye washers, then stuff firmly
R13	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	-
R14	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	-
R15	[sc, dec] x 6	(12)	last pinch of stuffing
R16	dec x 6	(6)	close the hole

Eyes & head size: the 12 mm eyes go in between Rnds 9 and 10, 7 stitches apart and a touch low on the face (7 sts is about 32 mm, just under half the head width). LOCK THE WASHERS at about Rnd 12, while you can still reach the inside: press each washer on until it clicks. The head stays open until Rnd 16 closes it - after that the washers are unreachable. Finished head about 70 mm wide x 67 mm tall.

2. Muzzle & nostrils - Yarn B

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	sc in each st around	(24)	face at full width, 35 mm
R6	sc in each st around	(24)	-
R7	sc in each st around	(24)	-

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R8	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	rim = 26 mm across

Finish: FO with a 40 cm tail and stuff lightly. The muzzle FACE is about 35 mm across (the wide cream patch you see); the RIM it sews by is about 26 mm, spanning roughly four rounds of head. Pin the top edge just under the eyes at Rnd 10 and let the lower edge fall at Rnd 13, clear of the Rnd-14 neck seam. Centre it, let the face sit a little wider than the eye spacing, and sew about three quarters of the rim with small whip stitches. Add a whisper more stuffing, then embroider the nostrils and mouth.

Knot the nostril and mouth ends inside the muzzle through the remaining opening before finishing the seam.

Nostrils (Yarn C): two short vertical satin stitches, 3 stitches apart, on the lower third. Mouth: one tiny horizontal stitch or a shallow V below them. Secure both before the last quarter of the muzzle seam is closed. (The eye washers were already locked before the head was closed at Rnd 16.)

The wide cream muzzle, low-set eyes and shaggy fringe give the Highland stare.

3. Body - Yarn A

Worked bottom up. The neck is left open at 18 stitches for the head join.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	-
R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	-
R7	[5 sc, inc] x 6	(42)	-
R8	[6 sc, inc] x 6	(48)	front legs join R8 - R9
R9	sc in each st around	(48)	-
R10	sc in each st around	(48)	body at full width, 70 mm
R11	sc in each st around	(48)	-
R12	sc in each st around	(48)	-
R13	sc in each st around	(48)	-
R14	[6 sc, dec] x 6	(42)	-
R15	sc in each st around	(42)	-
R16	[5 sc, dec] x 6	(36)	-
R17	[4 sc, dec] x 6	(30)	stuff firmly, pack the base
R18	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	-
R19	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	leave neck OPEN

Finish: FO with a 40 cm tail; do not close. Body is about 19 rounds (79 mm); with the head seated on the neck ring the finished sitting height is about 15 cm / 6 in.

4. Belly patch - Yarn B (optional)

A flat oval worked around a chain, sewn on last.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
Found.	ch 9	-	-
R1	sc in 2nd ch, sc in next 6, 3 sc in last ch, sc in next 6, 2 sc in last loop	(18)	-
R2	inc, 6 sc, inc x 3, 6 sc, inc x 2	(24)	-
R3	sc, inc, 6 sc, [sc, inc] x 3, 6 sc, [sc, inc] x 2	(30)	-
R4	2 sc, inc, 6 sc, [2 sc, inc] x 3, 6 sc, [2 sc, inc] x 2	(36)	-

Sl st, FO with a long tail; sew centred on the front with the lower edge about 3 rounds up from the base. Skip it for a plain ginger front - both are correct.

5. Legs - start with Yarn C, change to Yarn A (make 4)

Choose one pose before making the legs:

- **Low Highland sit:** make all four standard 16-round legs. The sewing angle creates the splay.
- **Tidier upright sit:** make two standard 16-round back legs and two shortened 10-round front legs from the separate table below. Do not make four long legs for this option.

Standard 16-round legs

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR (Yarn C)	(6)	hoof
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	sc in each st around	(18)	-
R5	sc in each st around	(18)	-
R6	BLO sc around	(18)	change to Yarn A - ridge
R7	sc in each st around	(18)	-
R8	[sc, dec] x 6	(12)	stuff hoof firmly
R9	sc in each st around	(12)	-
R10	sc in each st around	(12)	-
R11	sc in each st around	(12)	-
R12	sc in each st around	(12)	-
R13	sc in each st around	(12)	upper leg light
R14	[2 sc, dec] x 3	(9)	-
R15	sc in each st around	(9)	-
R16	sc in each st around	(9)	leave top open

A standard leg is about 67 mm. For the low Highland sit, pin the front pair about 55 degrees from vertical and the back pair about 68-70 degrees from vertical (nearly horizontal). The low join and long leg create the splay.

Shortened front legs - upright option (make 2)

Rnd	Exact instruction	Sts	
R1	With Yarn C, 6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
R4	sc in each st around	(18)	
R5	sc in each st around	(18)	
R6	BLO sc in each st around; change to Yarn A after the round	(18)	
R7	sc in each st around	(18)	
R8	[sc, dec] x 6	(12)	
R9	sc in each st around	(12)	
R10	sc in each st around; stop here	(12)	

Short-front finish: each leg measures 42 mm with a 12-stitch top opening. Stuff the hoof firmly, keep the final two rounds lightly filled, and FO after Rnd 10 with a 40 cm sewing tail; do not close or flatten the opening.

Short-front placement: pin both front legs before sewing, centred across Body Rnds 8-9, 8 body stitches apart. Start each leg 55 degrees forward from vertical, the same angle as the standard front legs; mirror the pair and adjust only within 45-65 degrees until both hooves rest level. Sew all 12 top stitches to the body, then make a second complete seam pass. Keep the standard 16-round back legs at 68-70 degrees from vertical.

6. Ears - make 2 of each layer

INNER ear - Yarn B (make 2) & OUTER ear - Yarn A (make 2)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	[sc, inc] x 3	(9)	-
R3	[2 sc, inc] x 3	(12)	-
R4	sc in each st around	(12)	-
R5	sc in each st around	(12)	-
R6	[2 sc, dec] x 3	(9)	-
R7	sc in each st around	(9)	OUTER ear only

Work the INNER ear through Rnd 6 only and the OUTER ear through Rnd 7; do not stuff either layer. Both openings have 9 stitches, but the one-round-shorter inner cup nests without bunching. If your cream yarn is thicker, use a 3.0 mm hook for the inner layer only. FO the inner ear with a short tail and the outer with a long tail. Push the inner cup inside the outer cup, aligning the magic-ring tips and the two 9-stitch openings, with cream visible at the front. Tack the two tips together with the inner-ear tail so the layers cannot shift. Join the openings stitch-for-stitch with 9 whip stitches (or 9 sc through one opening stitch from each layer) using Yarn A. Flatten the joined opening and pinch it with 2-3 stitches so the ear cups forward.

7. Horns - Yarn B (make 2)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	4 sc in MR	(4)	-
R2	[sc, inc] x 2	(6)	-
R3	sc in each st around	(6)	-
R4	sc in each st around	(6)	-
R5	[2 sc, inc] x 2	(8)	-
R6	sc in each st around	(8)	-

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R7	sc in each st around	(8)	stuff tip only

FO with a tail; stuff the tip only. Short and slightly curved - tilt each horn out and a little back when you sew.

8. Tail - Yarn A

Cut 6 strands of Yarn A, each 22 cm / 8.5 in. Fold the bundle in half and attach with a lark's head at the centre-back just above the last increase round: pull the folded loop through a stitch, then the tails through the loop. Folding gives 12 hanging ends; divide into 3 groups of 4, braid 4 cm, knot firmly and trim into a small tassel.

9. Fringe - Yarn A

Attach AFTER the horns and ears so you can part the hair around them. Cut 45 strands, each 14 cm / 5.5 in (43 to use plus 2 spares; swap up to 6 for Yarn C for depth). Attach 43 strands with lark's head knots in a horseshoe from one ear, across the brow, to the other, filling three rows across the front of the head: every stitch along the front of Rnd 8 (24 knots), then every other stitch along the front of Rnd 7 (about 10 knots) and Rnd 6 (about 9 knots) - 24 + 10 + 9 = 43 knots.

Tousle, then trim so the fringe grazes the eyes and breaks into uneven points. Highland hair is weather-beaten, not a salon fringe.

10. Tartan scarf - Yarn D (optional)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
Found.	ch 61	-	-
Row 1	hdc in 2nd ch from hook and in each ch across	(60)	-
Row 2	ch 2, turn, hdc across	(60)	turning ch does not count

FO; add a 3-strand tassel at each end or weave a second colour as a slip-stitch stripe to hint at tartan, then tie loosely under the muzzle. Ribbon shortcut: 28 cm of 12 mm rust tartan ribbon, knotted once.

Finishing & assembly

Assembly - work in this order:

Muzzle & face sewn (section 2) - the eye washers were locked before the head was closed at Rnd 16.

Horns between Rnds 5 and 7, 6 stitches apart, angled out and slightly back.

Ears just outside and below each horn, centred on Rnds 8-9, cupped forward.

Fringe attached and trimmed (section 9), parting around horns and ears.

Head to body: seat the head’s small Rnds 15-16 closing nub INSIDE the body’s open 18-stitch neck. Match the 18 body Rnd-19 stitches one-for-one to the 18 head stitches of Rnd 14, forming a full circular seam around the nub; do not bunch all 18 neck stitches into the 6-stitch closure. Pack the neck firmly, ladder-stitch around TWICE and tilt the muzzle slightly down.

Back legs: lower sides across Rnds 3-6, almost on the base, splayed near horizontal.

Front legs: FRONT across Rnds 8-9, about 8 sts apart, angled forward about 55 degrees.

Belly patch - only if you made it.

Tail & scarf: attach the tassel tail, tie the scarf, weave in every end and fluff the fringe.

Troubleshooting

- **He will not sit.** Restuff the body base firmly and sew the back legs lower and wider - closer to horizontal than you think.
- **Front hooves float.** Sewn too high - they belong on Rnds 8-9, not under the neck. If they still float, the legs are too long: work the front pair to Rnd 10.
- **Stuffing shows.** Drop half a hook size, or hold a matching thread with the yarn on visible rounds.
- **Face looks blank.** The eyes are too high. Low eyes plus a wide muzzle is the Highland stare.
- **Fringe is sparse.** Add a fourth row behind the horns and mix in one darker shade.
- **Horns flop.** Under-stuffed at the tip, or sewn only at the edge - stitch a full round into the head fabric.
- **Head tips forward.** Check that the 18-stitch neck is sewn around all 18 stitches of head Rnd 14, with the Rnds 15-16 nub tucked inside rather than used as the seam. Pack the neck and make the second ladder-stitch pass tight.

Colorways

Ginger · Caramel · Highland black · Cream · Roan red

Three sizes, one pattern

Version	Yarn / hook	Eyes	Height
Wee Hamish	DK / #3 - 2.75 mm	8-9 mm	~12 cm
Classic	Worsted / #4 - 3.5 mm	12 mm	~15 cm
Cuddle Hamish	Bulky chenille / #5 - 5.0 mm	16-18 mm	~21 cm

Stitch counts stay the same; only yarn, hook and stuffing change. Yarn scales with the square of the height and stuffing with the cube - buy generously for the big chenille version.

Designer notes

- Why the legs join so low: back legs (16 rnd, 67 mm, sewn to Rnds 3-6) and front legs (sewn to Rnds 8-9) splay at the checked angles so all four hooves land level. This low join is the most common failure on sitting Highland cows.
- Bottom-heavy by design: stuff the lower body firmly and keep the shape squat. Hamish is meant to settle onto his base and stare.

Care

Follow the labels for every yarn and component used. Before publishing a care claim or supplying finished Hamishes, clean and dry a complete sample by the proposed method, then remeasure it and inspect for dye transfer, fibre change, stuffing migration, loosened fringe, shifted eyes and opened seams. Until that sample test passes, recommend gentle surface cleaning with a damp cloth and drying flat away from heat. Check all eyes, knots and attachments again after cleaning.

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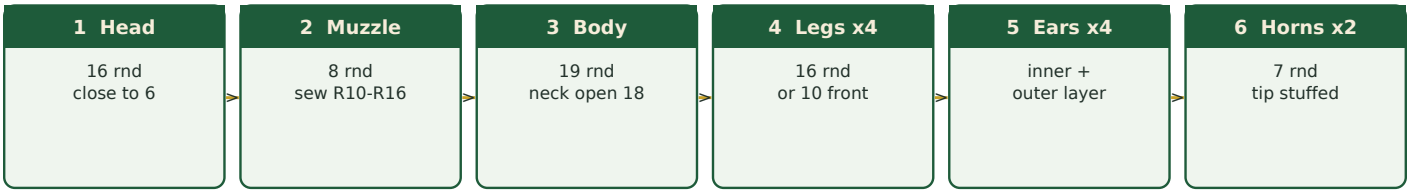
Safety reminder

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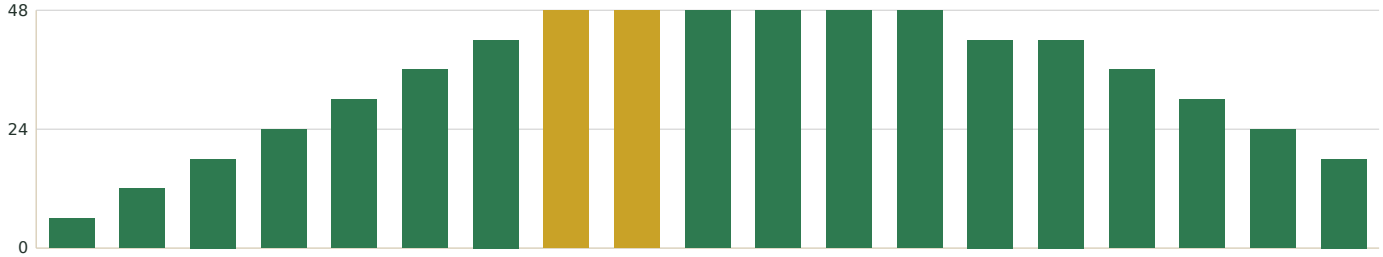
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Appendix A - Assembly Map & Count Chart



Assembly order: muzzle and face first, then horns, ears, fringe, head to body over the 18-stitch neck, legs, belly patch, tail and scarf last.



Stated stitch count per round. Gold bars = marked zones.

Appendix B - Count Ladder & Verification Summary

Rnd	Sts
R1	6
R2	12
R3	18
R4	24
R5	30
R6	36
R7	42
R8	48
R9	48
R10	48

Rnd	Sts
R11	48
R12	48
R13	48
R14	42
R15	42
R16	36
R17	30
R18	24
R19	18

Verification summary

Every round count in this pattern was re-derived from its own instructions by an independent auditor (PASS: 19 ladder rows, 0 mismatches) and by the deterministic static-analysis engine crochet-check v1.0.0. No count below is sampled or hand-checked.

Axiom	What it guarantees	Findings
Domain Isolation	Pieces keep separate stitch domains	0
Edge Lineage	Every round consumes exactly the previous total	0
Open Boundaries	Open edges are closed or sewn deliberately	0
Gauge Bounding	Hook and gauge band consistent with stated size	0

Assembly map, count chart, 36-row ladder equivalents and the 5-axiom table are computed from the corrected master at compile time; no sampled results.

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